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FROM THE PRESIDENTS' DESK

Dear Consulting Enthusiast,

I take immense pleasure in sharing Co2013 case book with you and I hope this document acts

as a good guiding document during your placement preparation process. With non-consulting firms also slowly shifting towards case based interview, I feel that case interview preparation is a good starting point for any type of interview preparation.

As with the standard consulting practice of 'Rule of 3', I have three messages that I would like pass on.

1. Consulting as a Career should be a carefully made decision – In a school like ISB, which is known for a high percentage of consulting jobs, it is easy to choose consulting as a career option without much thought. If you were to track the career evolution of the alums that joined consulting firms at ISB, you would find a slightly different story. Hence, I would strongly urge you to shed the herd mentality and evaluate the consulting as a career option very carefully.

Please ask yourself these questions before choosing consulting as a career –

- Have I done adequate research about consulting jobs or am I choosing it because it is 'preferred' by all students?
- What is a typical work week? What's the Career progression and what are the exit options?
- Does my current situation suited to get into a consulting job (Family situation, years of work experience, location & travel etc.)
- What do I want to do in long term? Can I start doing that right away after ISB?

2. Start early, Stay Focused – Preparing for consulting shortlists / interviews is by no means an easy job and the competition makes it even tougher. You should have a 'placement mind-set' right from Term 3 to be able to put your best foot forward. Later in this document, you'll find tips around resume writing along with tips for case interview preparation. Few basic rule of thumbs that I would want to leave with you
 - CGPA is important and most firms (not just consulting firms) would like to look at it. Don't focus on CGPA just for the sake of it, but try and ensure you've internalized all the concepts taught in the core terms – this helps a lot during interview preparation.
 - Networking, by itself, will not get you a shortlist – it just provides you with necessary information to equip yourself better for a shortlist / interview.
 - Excess networking not only confuses you with multiple opinions, but sometimes makes alum feel that you're being intrusive.
3. There are no set rules or frameworks to crack a consulting interview – Although this case book outlines a lot of best practices and frameworks, there's no best framework to solve a case. You'll notice in the case interview experiences that different candidates use different frameworks to

and prepare your own frameworks that you're most comfortable with.

I would also push you to go through case books from previous 2-3 years while you're preparing for the interviews. Books like Case in Point etc. are also a good source of case interview questions. But the best preparation for case interview is repeated case practice with your case group. While the ideal number of students in a case group is arguable, a three to five member group would be best to work with. The ideal time to start case interview preparation would be immediately after the first few consulting shortlists are out (typically during mid to end October, if Day 1 is scheduled mid-December).

I wish you all the best with you placements and sincerely hope you get your dream jobs. I'd like to thank all my colleagues who contributed their case interview experience for this case book. I'd also like to thank the alumni involved in guiding us through our placement process as well as contribute ideas to this case book. I'd also like to thank my core team especially Prateek Trivedi, Anshul Singhal and Apeksha Khandelwal in drafting Co2013 Case Book – without you guys, this case book would have never taken shape.

Warm Regards,

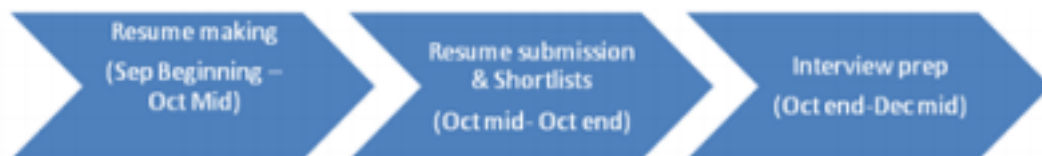
Manoj Muthu Kumar & Ankur Seth

Presidents, Consulting Club, Co2013

CV/COVER-LETTER PREPARATION

Introduction

Resume building marks the start of the placement preparation at ISB. It is the pamphlet you will need to advertise yourself to every potential recruiter of interest. A resume is a tool which effectively communicates your story and differentiates you from other candidates. It is 'not' a laundry list of achievements you might have had in your life. Rather it should be a list of 3-4 strong points which are able to highlight your key skill sets and achievements required for a successful management consulting career. It is advisable to make extensive use of the KM portal & start your CV preparation immediately after Term 3.



Expectations of top consulting firms from a good resume

Each consulting firm on campus has its own subjective/objective criteria of shortlisting of resume. It completely depends on how you can highlight the relevant skill-sets better than others and convince the firm that you have the 'spike' in your resume. Typical characteristics

that firms look for in a candidate are:

1. Analytical skills
2. Problem solving horsepower
3. Communication
4. Leadership
5. Client/Senior Leadership management
6. Business/Commercial knowledge
7. People Skills
8. Creativity
9. Quality of work experience
10. Non-Academic initiatives

STEP 1: Making the first draft

A good way to start preparing your resume is to write down all the achievements you have had on a piece of paper. Once this activity is done, start prioritizing your achievements. Make sure you give equal weightage is given to all the sections of your resume – academics, work experience and extra-curricular

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while selecting your achievements for the resume. You have only one page to advertise yourself. Use every line of your resume wisely. Make sure that your achievements are recent but more importantly give an underlining story about you as a person.

A good framework to draft your bullet points in an effective and impactful manner is context-action impact. For a good bullet point, make sure all these elements are mentioned. Impact if quantified through numbers or comparison with known references leaves a better impression than an unquantified one. For e.g. “Youngest to get promoted in 2 years” is good but “Youngest to get promoted in 2 years against an average of 4 years” makes it even more impactful.

What constitutes a ‘spike’ in your resume?

You will hear this word umpteen number of times and still would fail to understand what it actually means to have a ‘spike’ in your resume. The boundaries surrounding the ‘spike’ are very vague as you guys will find out as your ISB journey goes along. In all humility, let me try and pen down my understanding of this mysterious word. You need spike in any one of the three sections to get attention of the reviewers:

Spike in academics: If you are among the top 10% of the ISB class. Extraordinary grade in your undergraduation. Extraordinary GMAT score.

Spike in work experience: Brand value of your previous organization. Role and responsibility handled in your previous job. Any significant value addition to the organization.

Spike in extra curriculars: Any significant position of responsibility (in ISB or outside). Extra-ordinary achievement in sports/cultural events etc. can be used here. It is noteworthy not to write something very inconsequential. Remember what you write as an achievement is reflective to the company of what you think is an achievement? (THINK RELEVANT)

This illustration by no means implies that if you don't have these things on your resume, your chances of getting shortlist are by any means less. These are hygiene factors in resume which enhance your chances of getting a shortlist from a consulting firm.

STEP 2: Quick Tests to check your CV's effectiveness

"So what?" test

For every bullet point you write, you should ask yourself "so what if I did ____". For e.g. if I have led a team of 5 people on xyz assignment resulting in 10% cost saving. Now you should ask yourself "so what if I have done this". Is this a strong enough differentiator for it to come on my CV? Does it suggest a strong skill required for consulting which gets communicated through this point and appears nowhere else on my resume? Is it something which sets me apart from the rest or makes for an interesting read for the reader? If answer to any of the questions above is yes, then keep the point or else discard it.

Half Page test

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Once the first draft of your resume is done, take a printout and fold it into half along the longer side such that only the first half of every bullet point is visible. See whether the first half of every bullet point gives the reader an idea of the content of the bullet point. If yes, the bullet point is correctly framed or else you have to reframe the point in such a way that the first 4-5 words describe the point.

This rationale behind the test is as humans, we tend to focus more on the initial part of sentence while scanning. Details in the middle part or the latter part of the sentence tend to get missed out when we are hurrying through things.

30 second Test

This should be done when you have almost reached your final version of resume. Give your resume to one of your friends who hasn't seen your resume before for exactly thirty seconds. Take back your resume after 30 seconds and ask him/her what he/she remembers about your

resume and looking at the page, what he/she can make of you as an individual in one line.

This test gives a check of whether the storyline you want to communicate through your resume is actually getting communicated to a third person. If not, you need to focus more on the points which reflect your skills sets and leave an impression on the reviewer.

STEP 3: Making the final draft

Once you have the draft resume with you, make sure that it sees enough eyes other than you so that you get a feedback on whether your resume communicates the messages you want it to convey or is it just another laundry list of bullets. Share your resume with your friends/family and ask them to comment and ask difficult question. This is where your alums can be very helpful. Reach out to them and seek their advice on how your resume can be improved. This process is very iterative and takes most of the time in resume building.

Some Dos and Don'ts

Do's

- 1) Think about your story in one line much like the positioning statement of a product fund of marketing and make sure that your resume resonates with the theme
- 2) Check and double check any spelling mistakes. Take sample printouts to check for the margins.
- 3) If possible, stick to the ISB format. Don't try to be extravagantly different in format.
- 4) Get constant feedback from family/friends/alums on your resume.
- 5) Visit the KM portal and look at previous years' resumes of people who were shortlisted and finally got the offer.
- 6) Use informational interviews rather than company presentations and websites to find out what is really different about each firm, and why you would be a good fit.
- 7) Think carefully about which of the three typical CV formats (Chronological, Skill-Based or Hybrid) you should use – there is no one “right answer” for everyone.

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Don't

- 1) Mention anything fake or something you would not be able to pull off in the interview. Remember, honesty is always the best policy.
- 2) Inflate numbers or your responsibility/work area. Interviewers have been shortlisting resumes every year and can differentiate actual from inflated.

SUGGESTED TIMELINE TO BE FOLLOWED

The ideal time to start with your resume first draft is somewhere near mid-term 3. Take at least a week to figure out your story i.e. how would you like to put forth your candidature. Have a look at various resume of previous years on KM Portal. Also, get acquainted with ISB resume format

by end of term 3.

First week of term 4 should start the iterative process of refining your resume. Contact alums/consulting club members/family/friends and start taking their opinions about the resume.

Towards the start of term 5, make sure you have a semi-finished draft in your hand. There will be a lot of resume review workshops conducted by CAS/ professional clubs/ consulting firms. Make sure that you take full leverage of these workshops to fine tune the shortcomings in your resume.

COVER-LETTER

It is your expression of interest for the job posting and is very important for some firms like Booz, Parthenon etc. Few points to note while writing expression of interest are:

- 1) Give a personalized reason in your cover letter for why you are the best candidate for the job. Be sure to make a bridge between what you have done, where you want to work and how the particular job posting help you to achieve your career goal.
- 2) You need to exhibit some knowledge about the firm and demonstrate a fit between the company and yourself. Previous years' EOI on KM Portal, alums working in the firm and company's website might come in handy for gathering information about the company. 3) Address the EOI to the right person and the firm ☺.
- 4) Do not copy letters or pieces of letters from sample sources. Recruiters do recognize them easily.
- 5) Do not exceed 1 page for the cover letter.
- 6) Do not use any fluffy or generic statements about yourself or your experiences (e.g. excellent interpersonal skills, team player) unless you back them up with tangible examples.
- 7) Do not use generic statements about the company you are applying to (e.g. leading firm, excellent reputation, blue-chip company etc.). For one, this also applies to most of their competitors. For another, this shows that you have not done your homework to identify why you really want to join the company.
- 8) Get your cover letter by at least two other people to check for spelling mistakes, grammatical errors and ease of reading.

CASE INTERVIEW OVERVIEW

What are case interviews and what do firms look for?

These are typically excerpts from the business problems consultants solve for their clients. In such interviews interviewers give the candidate a problem and ask what should be done to solve it. The interviewer expects the candidate to logically approach the problem and attempt to solve it taking care of all angles. These interviews can be divided into two types – guess estimates and business problems.

Guess estimates are focused towards assessing the analytical skills of a candidate. The business cases used in interviews mostly do not have a pre-determined answer and candidates are evaluated based on how he/she deals with the problem. Assessment is done based on how one approaches the problem and if one can reach a well-supported conclusion. Ability to prioritize issues and exercising judgment based on the business context is crucial to the process.

Approach to the case and insights demonstrated helps a candidate in showcasing his/her potential and earn brownie points.

How to prepare (Tips)

- Read through few cases to get an understanding of what case interviews

- are like • Form a case group (3-4 people)
- In each case practice session, 1 person act as interviewer, 1 interviewee and 1-2 observers
- Try to develop your own customized frameworks for different types to cases (can use the frameworks in the book as a starting point)
- Take feedback from the observers to improve your solution
- Take feedback from alums ☺

CASE SOLVING APPROACH

Case solving can be divided in five steps –

- 1) Problem definition and scoping
- 2) Structuring
- 3) Analysis
- 4) Synthesis

PROBLEM DEFINITION & SCOPING

Understand the company and its business. You should be able to create a mental image of the company and its business. Figure out where the business is operating. What does the company do? How is it placed competitively etc?

Analyze EVERY WORD of the problem statement and ask clarifying questions w.r.t. that. Understand what caused the problem and what has been the impact.

Keep the 3Cs (Customer, Company and Competition) and 2Ps (product and price) in mind at all times when solving a case. Whenever you're stuck, revisit these.

Think along basic cuts like:

- a) Internal vs. external
- b) Short term vs. Long term

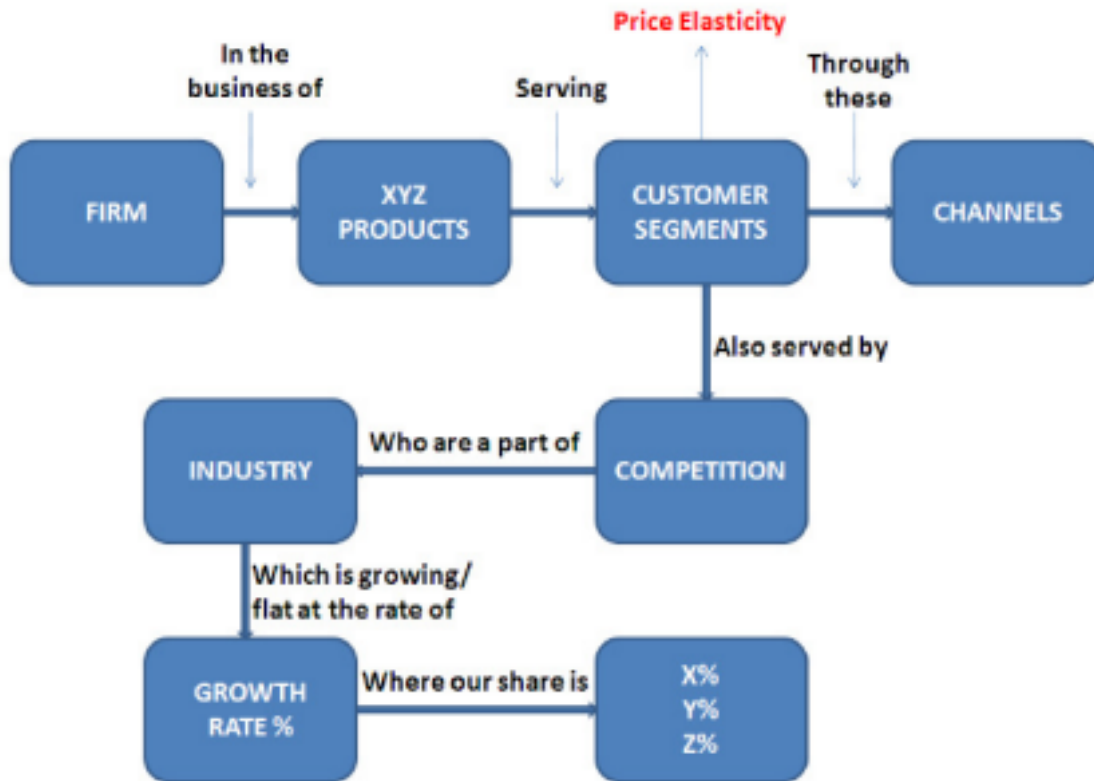
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- c) Current state vs. desired state (desired state can be understood through objectives/ goals/motivations of the management)

Segmentation: This is one of the most crucial and often overlooked steps. Always break the problem by company segments before applying any standard framework. Understand which part of the business the problem lies in. For e.g. think along the below segments:

- a. Customer segments
- b. Product segments
- c. Geographic segments
- d. Segments in terms of different parts of the value chain
- e. Different channels of distribution

PROBLEM LANDSCAPING DIAGRAM



At this point, you should've a pretty good hold of defining what the actual problem is. It helps to paraphrase or summarize the problem statement more tangibly at this point.

Problem Structuring:

1. Build out a quick approach of what the key issues are that we need to tackle, and what is the sequence you intend to follow.
2. Communicate this approach to the interviewer
3. Then build out a MECE structure.

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When building a structure:

Note making clarity is important

Visualize the case. Put yourself in the CEO's shoes. It helps!

Don't try to force fit frameworks. Always approach a problem based on first principles.

Frameworks will support your analysis.

Communicate the structure to the interviewer and get his buy in.

Analysis:

Develop a hypothesis for where the problem might lie. Then ask questions and collect more information to prove/disprove it

Make it a collaborate process. Do not treat it like an interview. It's not meant to be that.

Treat it like a real project and that you're working with a colleague on the project.

Ask for numerical data at every level of structure before going deeper. This is required until you figure out whether it's a numerical problem or not.

Speak with conviction and bring creativity into your solution.

In case of numbers, take your time. Do not sacrifice accuracy for speed.

Synthesis/summary:

It is effectively an answer to the client's problem. Make your recommendation and provide 2-3 strong supporting reasons for it. Follow it up with considerations / risks that may be involved with the strategy. Overall synthesis should not exceed a minute ideally.

Important Tips:

Always define the problem again and ask if your understanding is correct

Always take a buy-in on your framework before you proceed

Show the inherent excitement to solve the problem – your eyes should sparkle once you identify an issue

Once you identify a core issue – always think “Why” is it happening – shows that you want to really solve

Use interesting representations for communicating your ideas such as graphs, it is important to get the interviewer interested in your solution. Implementing various concepts taught in classes would also come handy.

While solving a case think yourself as an equal to the interviewer and try to build a personal connect with him/her. This would make you feel comfortable and interviewer more involved. At the end of the day, interviewer should be comfortable working with you in his/her team.

PROFITABILITY FRAMEWORK

Factors governing Mkt. Share	Possible Reasons
SOV – <i>Share of Volume (Awareness)</i>	-Promotional Spending - Promotional Mix - <i>Channels, Content</i> - Promotional Efficiency – <i>Ad \$ spend into Revenue \$</i>
SOM – <i>Share of Mind (Likeability)</i>	-Products – <i>Price, Quality, Usage</i> - Service – <i>Sales People Behavior/Skill, Customer Relationship Processes</i>
SOD – <i>Share of Distribution (Accessibility)</i>	-Distribution Partners – <i>Trade Mix, Inventory Management, Transport</i> - Supply matches Demand?

Profitability cases are the most common type of cases that you will see. The importance of the case stems from the fact that profit-making is the final goal of every business problem. It is always recommended to think on first principles when you approach a case-problem. Here we will try to run through the anatomy of a profitability case.

Breaking profitability down to its simplest components is the key in consulting cases. Dividing profitability into components such as revenue and cost can be helpful in discovering the causes of a less than favorable bottom line. It is to be noted that many a time, the interviewer will not specifically mention the type of the case. The candidate is expected to follow a sequence of logical steps by gathering information (by asking relevant questions). The structure shown above will be useful in exploring how to go about exploring the case.

The profitability problem is very vast and generally comes in varied dimensions. Thus, scoping of the problem becomes very important in order to make a structured headway in the case. This could be done by asking a sequence of logical questions. The idea behind these questions is two-folds – a) to scope the problem, b) to gather relevant information available with the interviewer.

Defining the problem

1. What is the magnitude of loss/profit? Since when has the trend occurred?

Also, it is noteworthy to inquire if profits are declining or profitability has been affected. (These are two different things. Profits are merely a difference of Revenues and Cost, while Profitability is a measure of profit margin.

- Gross profit, operating profit and net profit

SG&A + R&D + Restructuring +
Profit = Revenue-COGS - - Licensing and
regulatory

Red: Operating profit

Green: Net profit

Dep/Amort + Interest + Tax + Writeoff +
Losses/gains

Blue: Gross profit

Q2) Ask if gross margin/operating margin or net margin which is facing the decline?

Now, going ahead with the framework, we first define profits as 'Revenues – Cost'. Thus, it is a function of two drivers. We deep dive into one driver and hold on to the second one for the time being.

Q3) What is the target of profit / profitability? Any other constraints or secondary objectives (eg market share)?

Q4) Is there a timeline that the company wants to solve the problem in?

Q5) Just to get a background of the company, I would want to know the product mix and revenue streams for the company.

Q6) Ask for data on trends of each product and ascertain the product(s) which is leading to the problem.

Q7) Is the profitability problem across the industry and trends for the product? If problem is across the industry ask for context

- Demand

- Macroeconomic factors
- Changing priority of customers – change in demographics

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- Regular market disruptions

- Supply

- Regulatory – change in policies
- Increase in fragmentation (high supply, low demand) – leading to commoditizing the product

Q8) Competitive landscape – No of competitors, market share and its trend

Define and reiterate the statement: Improve Profits in X product from A% to B% by n

years. A brief structure as below would help to landscape the problem -

Structure

The problem may lie in two areas - revenue and costs. What are the trends of revenues (up or down) and costs (up or down)?

Depending on the response, choose which one to go in first and take buy-in of interviewer

REVENUES

Revenues are dependent on two factors –

Average Price

Thus, if revenue side has been affected then either Average Price across the product mix has decreased (majorly due to competition or company policy). Quantitatively, we can see that –

$$\text{Average Price} = \text{Price of all the products} / \text{Total number of products}$$

Here, the advice is to stick to first principles and be aware of the fact that Price of the products in the product mix and total number of products could also affect the revenues.

Internal factors -

Company tried to reduce price to increase revenues but it backfired

- Increased price because costs increased
- Transfer pricing (may be relevant if problem is limited to a division of a company)

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External Factors

- Price war
- Other stakeholders demanding more in value chain eg – increased distributor margin
- Government regulation (price cap)
- Customer preference changed. Had to reduce price

Resolution:

- Product Differentiation –
 1. Better features
 2. Better brand
 3. Better packaging
- Innovative Pricing Methods
 1. Loss Leader Pricing/ Captive Pricing (Razor Blade),
 2. Bundle Pricing
- Different methods of pricing:
 1. Value based Pricing (Premium Pricing & Price Skimming)

Aspirational value of a similar product

Opportunity cost of not getting the product/service

It is also a function of the size of the target customer segment. As larger size would allow us to charge lesser than the maximum aspirational value in order to penetrate into the new market
 2. Cost plus Pricing

R&D Costs

Manufacturing/servicing/construction costs – Fixed and Variable Costs

Break-even costs, WACC
 3. Comparable (Parity) Pricing

Existing products with similar features => Marked Price + Mark-up

Existing products with superior features => Marked Price of the existing product + Value of additional feature to the customer

If no similar product exists, then consider => NPV of substitute product
- Bundling & Cross selling
- Consolidation: Acquire other markets players – Charge premium price, Have more units sold.

In case Product/Service mix – volume has changed....

Identify which product's relative volume increase has led to overall revenue decrease. For that

product, following parameters could be assessed –

Product Related Problem

- Poor product quality
- Problematic product mix

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- Inadequate breadth of product line
- Depth of product line
- Network effects with other products/complementary products Service

Related Problem

- Poor service quality
- High cost of service
- Training adequacy
 - Curriculum
 - Frequency of training
- Depth and Breadth

Volume

Ascertain changes in number of units sold. The two potential reasons for a volume decline are – a) Market share decline b) Market size decline

If Market share declines...

Market Share = %Aware X %Preference Buyers X %Available X % Time for adoption X %Repeat Purchase

- Price
 - Have these increased? What is the elasticity?
- Product
 - Share of Mind(Likeability)
 - Poor quality
 - network effect with other products
 - substitutes
 - product mix
 - better product in market
 - quality of service
 - Perception of poor quality but good product
 - check perception and preference map
 - If problem in perceptual map, check for accuracy in positioning
 - training adequacy (curriculum or frequency of training)

- Remember – The final consumer might not always be the purchase decision maker. There might be other stakeholders involved, for whom we might need to make the product attractive.

- Promotion

- Share of Voice (Awareness) – how to increase awareness. Check for failures in each of the following stages.

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- Promotion schemes for enabling purchase – eg financing options, discount

coupons etc $SOV \times SOM \times SOD = Availability \times Product\ Offering\ (Likeability) \times Accessibility$

One must try to think in terms of consumer purchase funnel -

- Place

- Share of Distribution (Accessibility) – penetration, trade mix, lead time, distributor margin (agency problem), sales force (less or not trained), Skill and will of sales force

If market size decline...

- Demand (mature stage in PLC)
 - Check product life cycle
 - Demographics change
 - Product obsolescence
 - Usage rate gone down

Solution – Ansoff Matrix

Same Product - New Market (Geographic expansion) Which geography? Consider risks such as • attractiveness of overseas market • can the firm establish competitive advantage by replicating the strategy • identify the right geographies Price: Play with elasticity (skim vs penetration)	New Product - New Market (Diversification) • Related diversification – developed market • Unrelated diversification – developing market • Look at synergies (asset utilization)
Same Product – Same Market (Market penetration) Capture market share: 4P, Product Mix Increasing the pie: New target segment (user), different application (uses), per customer consumption (usage). This is more applicable in mature/declining phase of industry life cycle	New Product – Same Market (Product Development) • Vertical integration • New product development based on attractiveness, capability (asset utilization)

- Supply (still in growth stage of PLC)
 - Are you the only supplier and constrained by supply?
Are the SKUs being offered being liked by consumer? Change in consumer preference for another SKU

Solution:

- Short term
 - Increase distributor margins
 - Target new segments
- Long Term
 - Launch new SKUs

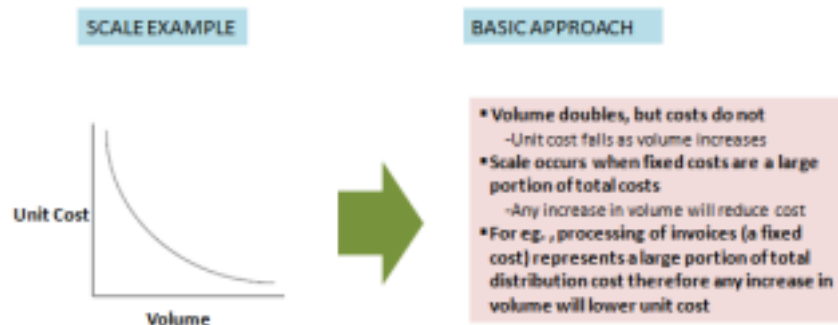
COST

Break the costs into

- a) fixed costs and variable costs

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- a. In a high fixed cost business there is very high temptation of price wars (Remember MADM fundas). For Fixed Costs, following considerations need be made –
 - a) Capacity Utilization
 - b) Increasing the scale of business/manufacturing – What causes it?



- c) Complex Product: High Costs - What causes it?

Complexity arises from additions to number of different products produced or activities managed -

Often without increase in overall volume

That cannot be added at low marginal cost or minor adjustments in production/staffing

Complexity can arise in numerous parts of cost structure –

Manufacturing: machine change-over and setup; increased inventory

- Starter runs: Machine changeover and setup
- Higher inventories: especially if little interchangeability
- Additional/longer product lines: often at lower volumes

Sales/distribution

- Sales force requires in-depth knowledge of full product line
- Increased storage facilities, distribution logistics
- Administration
 - Tracking and coordination issues

b. Remember it can be a product specific problem or a product mix problem something such as that we are selling more of higher cost product

b) Albeit simpler, FC and VC approach is considered limited in considering the entire set of costs related problem. Here Value Chain analysis helps us to consider all the costs in detailed.

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The value chain depicted above represents a manufacturing setup. However, thinking on first principles one can easily construct a value chain for any business mentioned in the case. For starters, think of Suppliers, Distributors (inbound/outbound), storage/warehouses, end customers (VERY IMPORTANT)

c) Costs income statement wise (COGS, SG&A, Interest, Depreciation, Tax)

What is the percentage split of costs across these different processes?

- In case one particular head has highest % say 50% or more then you can ask the interviewer that you would want to look at this head to start with.
- Many a time there might not be one major head and there could be two heads with 30%-30% split. In these cases you'll need to explore both heads and also see that the profitability decline could be partly because of one and partly because of another.

Exploring each head one by one

In case of manufacturing Industry,

- Raw Material Cost:
 - Start by asking type of good (Perishable/durable)?
 - Where does Competitor source from – does it get better prices?
 - If says same price, ask about efficiency of utilization – conversion ratio/wastage/efficiency for us. If efficiency is improved => less RM lead to reduced costs
 - If the problem is higher price or higher overall procurement cost then:
 - Resolutions
 - Substitution (Different Raw Material)
 - Cheaper material - indigenization/rationalization?
 - Quantity

- Value engineering (Use lesser Raw Material)

Per unit price

- Same Supplier
 - Better Negotiation/Bulk Order – Can you provide something in return for a better price?
 - Time of Sourcing (Opportunistic) – Buying when prices are low
- Alternate supplier
 - Currency Hedging – Use forwards/futures if prices are expected to rise. Also use call or put options for the variable part of future demand.

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- Standardization of Parts– ordering more of same type of good
 - Backward Integration
 - Cheaper supplier - china etc?

- Inbound Logistics:

- Do you and your competitor use the same Mode of Transportation?
- Do you incur the same rates and same overall cost?
- Explore Distance Travelled – could be that the rates are same but your factory is further away from the supplier base.
- Are you ordering at the Economic Order Quantity (EOQ) – Trade of between Set up cost, holding cost and expected demand

- Production/Operations:

- Explore Labour cost and efficiency vis-a-vis competitor.
- Inventory Cost (EOQ)
- Overheads such as Electricity/Rent same or higher?
- Machine Utilization: % Downtime - High?
 - Machine broken? Maintenance/spare cost
 - Power outage?
 - Labour unavailability?
 - Total availability will be a function of (% of time labour, % time machine available, % Idle time)
- Resolution – additional dimensions:
 - Outsource
 - Economies of Scale/Learning curve
 - Labour cost arbitrage

- Distribution/Outbound Logistics:

- Explore same as (Inbound)

- Post Sales Cost:

- Installation
- Service or Warranty cost?

- Gross margin is same but Operating margin has reduced:
 - Marketing & Administration – SG&A
 - R&D cost
 - Restructuring cost
 - Licensing and regulatory costs
- If NOPAT is down
 - Depreciation & Amortization
 - Interest Expense
 - Tax rates – which geographies (VAT) does our company operate in?
 - Inventory Write off
 - Gains/losses or external investments

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- Loss due to some catastrophic event.

MARKET ENTRY FRAMEWORK

To put it very simply, there are two basic considerations for market entry – a) Is it a good idea?
b) How to enter? We will try to put together a framework which strives to answer these two questions quite exhaustively.

Structuring the problem

Structuring a market entry case problem is a four step approach –

- 1) Deciding on the Goals/Objectives – a) Strategic Intentions b) Economic Intentions
- 2) Evaluating whether to enter the industry or not is a function of three parameters – a) Industry Attractiveness b) Financial c) Strategic Intentions.

The 3 parameter approach helps one to answer the two fundamental questions associated with market entry – a) Where to invest: Value chain wise, Geographically b) How to Invest: Mode of entry

1. GOALS/OBJECTIVES

Defining the problem

Q1. Motivation behind entry?

- a) Why into new industry?
- b) Why into this particular industry?
- c) Anything other than profits a motivation?

Q2. Target for profitability? Timelines?

- a) Cost of capital? Target Rate of Return?
- b) Target market share?
- c) Target revenues and target profits?

Q3. Any constraints on investment and scope of thinking?

- a) Levels of investment
- b) Geographies of investment

Q4. Understand the company, line of businesses and the existing business model

- a) Will help from the synergies point of view
- b) Corporate structure/Organization structure

2. SHOULD WE ENTER?

INDUSTRY ATTRACTIVENESS	- Market Size - Growth/life cycle - Value Cycle: competitors, substitutes, suppliers - Customers – WTP, Demand-Supply, price elasticity, backward integration, switching cost, brand loyalty - Barriers – Regulatory, forward integration, economies of scale - Risks – PESTLE Analysis: External Vs Internal
FINANCIAL GOALS	- Quantitative analysis to evaluate on the Financial Metrics (Mentioned Below)
STRATEGIC GOALS	-Organization Design/structure - Sustained competitive advantage: VRIO framework, Brand Equity, Market share gain, Patent/Proprietary Technologies - Cost-Benefit of entry: Economies of Scale, Supply Chain/Distribution Synergies, Breakeven is aligned with goals, competitive advantage

Industry Attractiveness – ANSWERING THE 'SHOULD WE ENTER?' QUESTION:

This part of the structure tries to determine how attractive the industry is? Sometimes one may be asked to evaluate/compare more than one option. At other times, you might be required to generate the options and the case opening can be vague. In such cases, the best option is to draw the value chain (with the help of the interviewer), and identify which part of the value chain the company should enter. A short-listing criterion like top decile of return and bottom decile of risk can be used. Whenever you have to make a choice, remember you need to develop a choice rule or mathematical metric of evaluation. However, the choice cannot be made entirely based on qualitative analysis and quantitative metrics need to be developed in order to exercise the choice. The metrics of evaluation could be –

Investment (Upfront, Change in Working Capital)

ROI/IRR/Payback Period

NPV/Profit

EVA – Economic Value Added: NOPAT – WACC x Invested Capital

Opportunity Cost of Investment

Real Option

Projected Cash flows
Terminal Value
Risk

A best case/worst case analysis can be performed if required.

Based on the above analysis, we can move towards evaluating the market entry case by using a Fundamental Attractiveness Vs Relative Competitive Positioning graph –

Fundamental Attractiveness:

- Barriers to Entry
 - Government Regulation
 - High Capital Requirements
 - R&D – IP/Patent
 - High Brand Equity
 - Human Capital – High Costs
 - Economies of scale/scope
 - Switching costs – Network Effects
 - Distribution Network
- Competition
 - Consolidated/Fragmented Market
 - Market Share distribution among competitors
 - Supplier/Distributor Channel – Strength & Weakness
 - Contractual customer lock-ins define market trends
- Buyer
 - Segment Growth
 - WTP – $f(\text{demand})$
 - Distributor Channel Preference (Outbound Logistics)
 - Demand-Supply Gap (Important)
 - Price Sensitivity – Ascertains whether to go for Premium Pricing or not
 - Threat of forward integration – VERY HIGH SUPPLIER POWER
 - Needs w.r.t current product mix being offered in the market
- Value Chain & Substitute products

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Switching cost of buyers/suppliers
Threat of backward integration – Competition might acquire vendors to control its supplies of RM et al.
Manufacturing Resources – Talent/Expertise availability?
Availability of substitute products?

Consumer Behavior evolutionary trends

Relative Competitive Positioning: f (Financial Goals, Strategic Goals)

Also, it is prudent to assess the relative competitive gains for our client on following parameters –

- Brand Equity
- Economies of Scale
- Supply chain/Distribution Synergies
- Market share gains
- Patent/Proprietary Technologies
- Organization Design/structure
- Cost-Benefit Analysis

Strategic Goals

Strategically, does it make sense for the company to enter the market?

Short Term (FIT) :

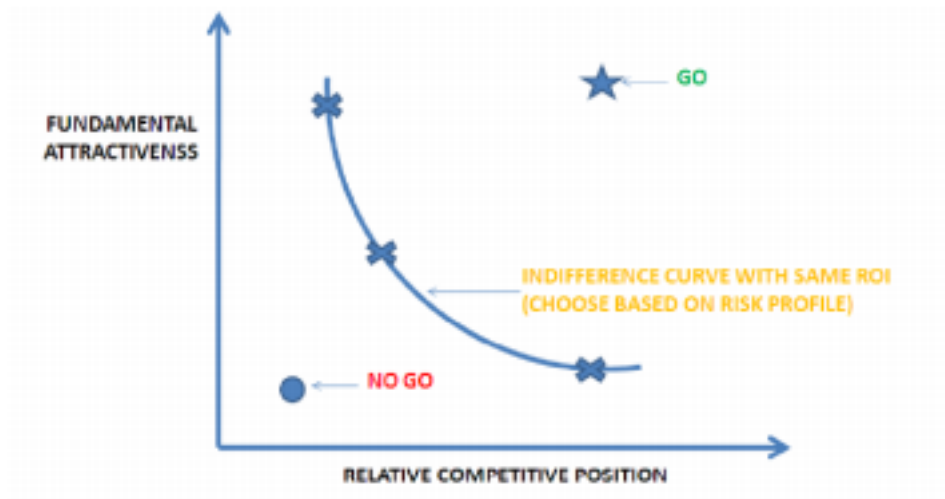
- Prior Experience in moving to new markets
- Synergy with existing operations
- Tactical Decision – 4Ps
- Game Theoretical perspective – Strengths/Weakness of each player
- Competition Response

Long Term :

How to build a sustainable competitive advantage?

- Create Barriers to Entry/Exit
- Create Customer Lock-ins

Now for case solving purposes we might as well plot the graph between Fundamental Attractiveness Vs Relative competitive positioning and mark the client's positioning on the graph on the basis of both qualitative and quantitative assessment made above. Graphical presentation of your analysis earns you more points –



4. MODE OF ENTRY – Evaluation matrix

√

√

√

√

√

√

Modes of Entry – ANSWERING THE ‘How to Enter?’ QUESTION:

- Evaluation Matrix

	Weights	Green Field	Franchise	M&A	JV
Investment/Payback Period/Break-even	40%				
Management Control	20%				
Cultural Fit	10%				
Risks	30%				
Availability	Essential				
Time	Essential				

**Weights mentioned above are subjective to the Evaluative metric(s) above*

Also, following parameters need be considered to ascertain how the weights are to be distributed -

- Risks

- Financial Risks –

- Cash position of the parent firm?

- Impact on the financials of the parent company if this new venture fails?

- Technology Risks

- Political Risk

- People Risk

- Management Control

Ability to monitor work	Easy	High Risk Equity research, litigation support, R&D support	Low Risk Transaction processing, insurance claims, customer service
	Difficult	Highest Risk Pricing, product design	Moderate Risk Supply chain coordination, customer data analysis
		Subjective	Objective
Precision of metrics used to measure process quality			

Keep in mind that nature of questions for Market Entry cases could be different –

- 1) Should I enter? – Assess only Industry Attractiveness
- 2) Which method to enter? – Assess Modes of Entry as well

- 3) Exactly where should I enter? – Use above mentioned frameworks Sector-wise priority

assessment, Geographical priority assessment (Parameters mentioned in 'Industry Attractiveness').

SYNERGIES	AFFECTED PARAMETERS	RESOLUTION
Revenue	ΔP	Charge high price due to improvement in quality
		Charge high price due to lower
	ΔQ	Bundling
		Improve Quality of existing products
		Cross Selling
		Combine capabilities in different parts of the value chain
Costs	COGS	Vertical Integration - low cost RM by mitigating holdup
		Sharing IT Technology
		Pooling manufacturing technology
	SG&A	Common sales and distribution force
		Combined advertising & Marketing spend
	Investments	Improve reinvestment ratio - Some new projects can now be undertaken
		Improve in working capital - Operation Cycle
		Improve return on capital (Reduce common assets & improve revenues)
	Depreciation	Assets purchased will be written up to market value => More Tax-shield
Financial	Tax Shield	Greater Tax Shield - Depends on tax laws
		Tax loss carry forward
	Bankruptcy Cost	Diversification will lead to reduction in probability of default
		Better Ratings
	Agency Cost	Earlier ignored positive NPV projects will now be taken up
	Internal/External Funding	Low cost of debt
		Low Beta (Risk)
		Improved D/E ratio
	Cost of asymmetric information	Internal capital allocation will be more efficient than external

Defining the Problem

Q1. Have the decision to merge/acquire been taken or not?

If the decision has to be taken then the above framework need only be used. Also, strategic and economic intent of the merger also has to be assessed. (Market Entry framework)

However, if the decision has been taken then above framework need only be used. Q2. Understand the business model of the acquirer and the target?

To understand synergies

Ask what assets (tangible and intangible) the target firm owns?

Q3. Motivation of the acquisition?

Structuring the case

Stakeholders – Acquirer stakeholders and target shareholders: It has to be decided during the case that whether the target shareholders would continue to exist after acquisition or not. The next job is to evaluate synergies, and how synergies would be split between Acquirer Shareholders and Target Shareholders.

$$EV \text{ (Enterprise Value)} = \text{Market Capitalization} + \text{Market Value of Debt} - \text{Cash}$$

Valuing Synergy:

1. Calculate standalone values of target [1a] and acquirer [1b]. Use FCFs discounted by WACC to get the value of the firm [Valuation done using FCFs]. Also, valuation could be done using multiples i.e. P/E, MV/EBITDA, EV/EBITDA, Price/Sales etc.

2. Calculate the value of target when optimally managed

3. Calculate value of the combined entity, with synergies accounted for [Acquirer + Target].

Synergy = 3 – [1a + ab] = Value of “Acquirer + Target” taken together – Value of “Acquirer” – Value of “Target”

If there are two acquirers – A1 & A2

Synergy = Value of “A1 + T” taken together – [Value of T + A1 (given A2 acquires T) taken separately] Here, calculate –

Standalone A1 (given A2 acquires T)

Standalone A2 (given A2 acquires T)

There accounts for the opportunity cost of not acquiring the target as well.

Price of Acquisition = Value of Target + Percentage of Synergy

SOURCES OF SYNERGY: As shown in the framework above.

Cash Vs Stock Deal in M&A

If stock of Acquirer is over-valued => Use Stock

If expected cost of Financial Distress is high, the debt financing is costlier => Use Stock If Acquirer is very large and has excess cash => Use Cash

If size of acquirer ~ size of target, then large cost of financial distress => Use Stock If D/E ratio of the Acquirer is very high => Use Stock



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DIVESTITURE FRAMEWORK

Defining the problem

What is the product/service that the client wants to divest from? Is it high/low margin business?

Since when are they in this business? Was it organically developed or acquired? Or is it a JV? Why does the company want to divest from this business?

Is it based out of any metrics, such as ROI, ROA, and Profit Margin?

- If yes, what has been the trend of this metric/profitability for the company? Is the market shrinking?
- Who are his key customers for this product?
- Who are the main competitors? What is the company's standing in this competitive landscape?
- Has something changed in the business landscape? Technology? Government Regulation

Structuring the problem (A concrete framework for the case would be ascertained once the problem has been defined on the basis of the questions above)

We have identified three basic causes for divestiture –

- Lack of Profitability
- Need for capital
- Identification and hence getting rid of the non-strategic unit

Analysis of the above three parameters can be done considering the framework mentioned above. Further following are important questions to analyze after the 'WHY/SHOULD DIVEST?' question has been answered using the above framework -

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• EVALUATION OF DIVESTITURE OPTIONS

Potential Buyers

Valuation of the Company – a) DCF Valuation b) Multiples

Valuations Reservation Price

• RISKS

Loss of strategic business entity

Loss of economies of scale/scope

Change in the cost structure could negatively impact the business Loss of Vertical Integration due to divestment

Long term growth plans are affected because of divestment

*Cases requiring a Sales Force Effectiveness framework mentioned below have seen an increased incidence over the last couple of years. We have tried to put together a comprehensive approach towards tackling such case problems.

SALES FORCE EFFECTIVENESS FRAMEWORK

PRICING FRAMEWORK

PRICING

COST BASED	COMPETITIVE	VALUE BASED
	of the Pricing Strategy	Select Target Segment
	Proxy Industries or	List alternatives and
COGS & Expected Margins	Products for any new	substitutes for the segment
Breakeven / Payback Period	products	Calculate Willingness to Pay
Price Elasticity	Information about Industry	range for the segment
Distribution & Logistics	structure (consolidated	Beware of Supply & Demand
Cost Product Mix / Line	vs Concentrated; price	This is usually the Upper Limit
Details Activity Based	wars etc.)	for the Pricing problem
Costing		
	This is usually in between	
	Cost and Value based	
This is usually the Lower Limit		

Tip: Many Pricing cases also turn out to be masked 'market demand estimation' cases. Defining the problem

- Identify if it's a bidding, auction or a straightforward pricing problem
- Get a clear picture of the product and the target customer segment
 - o Single product or product line?
 - o Commodity or differentiated product? Identity what value the client is adding to the customers?
 - o Is the product Luxury or Necessity? Is the product patented? Is it imitable easily?
- Get a clear picture of the firm and their objective with this product
 - o First time entrant? Does the firm want to grow the market share or Top-line?
 - o Does the firm want to push the competitor out? Does the firm want to play price war?

Structuring the Case

- The framework to solve pricing problems is relatively easy one
 - o Once the framework is laid, start getting in-depth in each bucket (Cost, Competitive and Value based
 - o Establish the border constraints (e.g. policies & regulations etc.)

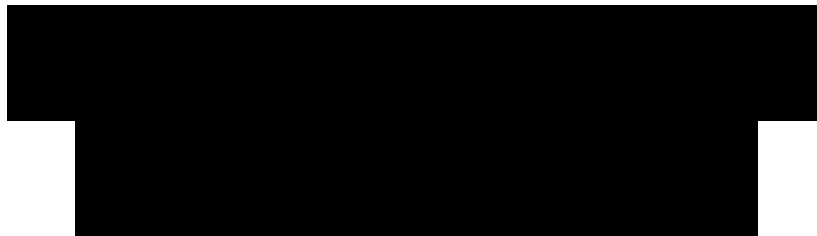
- o Once you calculate the lower and upper ends of the pricing, offer a rational explanation which price range you would choose

- Price lower than Value based pricing and above Cost based pricing calculations.
Reason: Customer switching costs, fluctuations in WTP etc.

Tips:

1. Many pricing problems are masked 'market size' estimation problems. When the conversation goes in that direction, ensure you specify that you'd calculate the market size before pricing the product
2. There's no single price – Always offer a price range. Mentioning the sensitivity metrics in calculations would fetch additional brownie points.
3. Think about competitive reaction in the market
4. Topics like bundling and other innovative prices (discount scheme etc.) will fetch brownie points

Following key aspects need to be evaluated in case any PE firm is considering making an investment in any industry/company. We need to start our assessment with the fund's motivation to invest and analyzing the attributes of the firm –



ACCENTURE MANAGEMENT CONSULTING

Name	Ankush Gandotra
Company Interviewed With	Accenture Management Consulting

Name of Interviewer and Designation	Senior Manager, don't remember the name
Round (First/Second/Third round)	Second (I had a total of 6 rounds, only first two were case based)
Personal interview Questions(with indicative answers if you choose to share them)	No PI questions in this round Straight to the case
Case Question	It was a hard core operations case (a possible indication where they want to place you). An iron ore miner transports the ore from the plant site to the sea via small boats. At the place of mining, there is a machine which constantly pours the ore into the boat. As soon as the boat is filled up, it carries the ore to the ship via river. The ore is transferred from the boat to the ship via cranes and the boat returns to the mining site after this. It takes a total of 40 hrs for one complete trip of the boat including loading and unloading. You have to reduce this boat cycle time to 30 hrs.

Narration of the case interview (please be as descriptive as possible)	Approach: I asked for some data about boat size, ship size etc. He gave me some numbers but I soon realized that problem is only to reduce the time. I then asked for some time to structure my thoughts and drew the whole chain (very important step as they want to see the structure, so write clearly and boldly). Four important steps were 1) loading at mining site, 2) ore transport to the sea, 3) unloading at sea and 4) back to the mining site. He gave me data that first step takes 4 hrs, second takes 6, third takes 4 and last step takes 6 hrs. That makes it a total of 20 hrs. I figured out that rest of 20 hrs is because of the queue at loading and unloading site. Now, I took each step separately and discussed how we can reduce time at each step (again, the structure is important, go one by one). Step 1: Faster loading, loading ships from two sides, two parallel sites for loading etc. Step 2: Boat might be older and slower, take alternate route for transportation etc. Step 3: Similar suggestions as step 1
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	Step 4: Similar suggestions as step 2 He agreed with all of them but told me that think of something else. I asked him how boat drivers are paid. He told that boats are contracted from third party and paid per hourly basis. I took some time here and figured out that number of boats employed by the contractor are far more than what was optimally required and hence the queue. So, reduce the number of boats.
What do you think went right for you in the in this interview?	Laid the structure well Always communicated my thought process (talk when you are stuck, it helps)

Any tips for the future batches based on this Interview experience.	Structure is important than the result Keep the interviewer engaged, he would help you if you talk to him Always keep the goal in mind and ask only those questions which are relevant. In this case, it was how to reduce time and nothing else. Go through the frameworks but don't force fit them into cases.
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Name	Anubhav Jha
Company Interviewed With	Accenture
Name of Interviewer and Designation	Kaustabh (not sure of designation)
Round (First/Second/Third round)	First
Personal interview Questions(with indicative answers if you choose to share them)	The interview started with a case which has been detailed below. Once the case was over, the interviewer asked a few expected PI questions - • You seem to have done some good work in finance and risk earlier. Why do you want to shift to consulting? • Why Accenture? • What are your strengths and weaknesses? The interviewer was an ISB alum and was quite picky about the answers I gave (especially strengths and weaknesses). He appreciated the fact that I seemed honest about my weaknesses (emotional, argumentative, underconfident) and mentioned that he disliked the typical MBA responses to these questions. However, be sure to show that you have worked on your weaknesses by stating examples.
Case Question	The interviewer mentioned that the client was a large UK based beer manufacturer that had been losing market share and asked to identify the possible reason(s).

Narration of the case interview (please be as descriptive as possible)	I clarified the objective and the interviewer stated that the only objective was to identify the reason for the decline. I asked a few basic questions regarding the company's operations – Q1) Is beer the only product that the company manufactures? A) Assume that to be true Q2) How long has the company been in operation and is UK the only market with which we are concerned? A) The company has been in operation for many years and is an established player. Yes, UK is the only market. Q3) When you say the market share has been declining, what exactly does that mean? Are we talking about volume or
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value?

A) Both volume and value have been declining (he gave me figures for the decline which I don't remember now)

Q4) Who are the main competitors? Has there been any significant change in their operations strategy over the past 2-3 years?

A) Surprisingly, the competitors have done nothing special over this period.

Q5) Has the industry been growing?

A) Yes

The interviewer seemed happy with the line of questioning. Once I had noted down the details I outlined my structure. I mentioned that it seemed like the problem was internal to the company and competitor action was not the cause of the fall in market share. To identify the possible reasons I said I would like to explore different aspects of the company's business to study past trends and see if the company had made any changes. At this point the interviewer urged me to draw out a MECE structure for analysis before I began. I outlined Product, Customers, Operations, Regulations and Competition and made several bullet points under each. The interviewer was happy with the structure and asked me to take up customers first. This gave me a hint that the problem may lie here and I dove into a line of questioning based on the points I had made.

I asked about main customer segments and explored the trend within each. It turned out that the company's main customer segment (80% of sales) were individuals above 50 years of age. The trend for other segments had been stable but sales to this segment had been declining. Taking this point forward, I asked if there had been any changes to the product in the recent period. The interviewer responded that the company had changed the colour of their beer (by reducing the wheat content) to a lighter shade. The main customer segment considered lighter coloured beers to be not strong enough and for "sissies". This basically concluded the problem identification

	question and the interviewer seemed happy with the line of questioning that led to the answer.
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	The interviewer went on to ask a few questions regarding the company's best response and how it can best go about implementing the recommendations (increasing wheat sourcing, launching a pilot to test the revised product).
What do you think went right for you in the in this interview?	I had a great discussion with the interviewer throughout which I felt was the key element. Even when I was stuck I kept the conversation going rather than stay shut and because of that he was willing to throw me a few hints. I was pretty calm and easy going through the interview which might have helped.
Any tips for the future batches based on this Interview experience.	Engage the interviewer. Keep sharing your thoughts while solving the case, even if they are not spectacular insights. Prepare well for the PI and be genuine! My personal suggestion would be to stay away from the typical MBA responses to such questions and say what makes sense to you personally. Outcome – Made an offer after a subsequent skill based and Partner round (did not go through an HR round)

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Interviewee Name	Prashant Yadav
Company Interviewed With and Role	Accenture, Consultant
Name of Interviewer and Designation	Kapil, Kaustubh, Nilesh(Partner)

Round (First/Second/Third round)	First
Group Discussion (write NA if not applicable)	NA
Personal interview Questions(with indicative answers if you choose to share them)	1. Three important learnings at ISB 2. What would I want to do post ISB and why 3. A walk through the resume 4. A brief intro to my industry – upstream oil and gas exploration. 5. Parallels between upstream oil and gas services industry to other services industries.
Narration of the case interview (please be as descriptive as possible)	1. Define a typical cycle for any oil reserve development process. 2. Estimate time breakup at each stage and levels of risks for the operating entity. 3. Which stage of this value chain presents the greatest opportunity for efficiency improvement and why.
Any other interview round (please mention the format and questions as part of your experience)	Round 3 (HR): 1. Three things about me that were not on the resume. 2. Three learnings at ISB those were not academic or professional. 3. Would I have any reservations about travel or work location 4. Recent updates in the oil and gas industry and their repercussion on future business opportunities.

	Round 4 (Partner): 1. Three aspects those are most critical to any offshore drilling services firm. 2. What qualities do I bring to Accenture, functionally and in terms of industry knowledge? 3. How can Accenture improve Project Management delivery for clients? 4. How would I identify inefficiencies at various stages in an upstream procurement and operations project? Which data would I investigate first and why?
Outcome	Offer was extended.
What do you think went right for you in the in this interview?	1. Most of the discussions were highly focused on industry. 2. I asked for specific information in certain cases and the interviewer was more than happy to explain in great detail. 3. Familiarity with business verticals and conversations with alums in Accenture that I could allude to while answering PI questions and as a general conversation in case interviews.
Any tips for the future batches based on this interview experience	Clearly, my interviews and case exercises were industry specific although they did pepper in a few general business case questions.

Name	Viraj Vikram Singh
Company Interviewed With	Accenture Management Consulting (AMC)

Name of Interviewer and Designation	Don't Know
Round (First/Second/Third round)	First
Personal interview Questions(with indicative answers if you choose to share them)	I came to Accenture right after giving 4 rounds at another firm. AMC kept calling me since long and so I rushed to the spot without having lunch. It was chiefly a first level screen and the interview was over in 15 minutes. 1/ Tell me about yourself I told about my professional experience with a touch of personal information 2/ Why Consulting more so when you have semiconductor design experience? I drew my organizational design, showed my interactions with stakeholders within the firm and tried to justify as to how the consulting role was similar to the uncertain nature of project and client management work in my previous organization. He looked convinced and agreed to all my points 3/ Any questions for me? I asked few clarifications on the differences between GTIN and IB and he was happy to answer in detail.
Narration of the case interview (please be as	No Case was asked

descriptive as possible)	
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What do you think went right for you in the in this interview?	I spoke confidently and gave structured responses which he liked.
Any tips for the future batches based on this Interview experience.	Prepare well for basic questions like “Tell me about yourself” and “Any questions for me”. People were filtered in the first round itself. I urge future classes to focus on PI as much as they do a case. Know basic differences between GTIN and IB (only for AMC) and your priorities before the interview.

Name	Viraj Vikram Singh
Company Interviewed With	Accenture Management Consulting (AMC)
Name of Interviewer and Designation	Mansi
Round (First/Second/Third round)	Second
Personal interview Questions(with indicative answers if you choose to share them)	Just after the first round, I got the SMS that I have not been selected in the last firm I interviewed with! I maintained composure soon as I was told to appear for the next round at AMC. Few basic PI questions were asked. Mansi appeared very serious and kept filling the evaluation sheet throughout the interaction. I was a bit anxious at the prospect of being evaluated continuously! 1/ Why Accenture I have attended the PPT and have done a lot of study online about it. She was satisfied with the response 2/ Have you not done any projects?

I realized that she was asking for ELP and I pointed to that section in resume and discussed it briefly.

After the Case:

3/ Are you comfortable with traveling?

I said I love to travel and it goes hand in hand with my photography!

4/ Tell me about your family?

I think she was planning to decide between GTIN and IB for me.

Narration of the case interview (please be as descriptive as possible)	It looked a real case. Mansi was poised and narrated the case in great detail Case: There is a client of us in commercial vehicle segment. The client is the market leader. They launched a ~1 Ton capacity mini truck some 5-6 years back that has done very well. The company is now thinking of entering the used vehicle market for this 1 Ton capacity truck. The problem is that the used commercial vehicle market has too many brokers and no big firm has entered this market. Also there is a difficult for financing as banks give 50% of the price while buyers of used truck want nearly 85% What will you suggest broadly? (There were some other nuances which I can't recall) Response: I restated the problem as too many details were given and ensured that I have understood it well. Then I asked some clarifying questions like the location (India) and whether they are leaders wrt unit or revenues or both etc I took a moment to structure the case. I knew structure may not be very important here and that the case may not have numbers since Manasi said she wants to know my solutions 'broadly'.
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I said that a cost-benefit analysis must be done before entering into this market. Also, the point that no big firm has ventured into this space is not a major worry and client can be the pioneer in this domain.

Since she asked pointed questions, I had to provide one-to-one answers to each question but still classified them broadly into external and internal.

The further sub classification done was:

1/ Brand Dilution Issue:

I suggested keeping a separate branding for used truck business to avoid brand equity dilution in existential market.

2/ Target Market and Cannibalization:

Although the targeted customers may be different from that for new trucks, there may still be some cannibalization.

The customers who are buying it from us as they can't afford a new truck: Cannibalization is not a major issue here.

Customers who can afford new truck but chose to buy used trucks from us as that fits their purpose:

Cannibalization may hurt here but we can also draw customers who may have purchased new competitors truck (may offset)

3/ Pricing, Guarantees and signaling:

I mentioned that client may offer guarantee (for limited time) to differentiate it from other brokers by signaling quality. The markup may be higher to cover higher costs and also for signaling/differentiation. They may do 20 or 30 point check as Maruti True Value does etc. Consumers may flock to us given our reputation and assurance and may be willing to pay slightly higher prices.

	4/ Supply side and dealing with brokers:
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To ensure supply of good used vehicles, we can offer schemes such as people can sell back their trucks after a shorter period (say 4-5 years when the life of truck may be 8- 9 years). We can then offer discounts on new trucks. This boosts the sale of new trucks as well and will provide us a continuing supply of used trucks which are in decent condition. The customer loyalty and retention will be high.

We can also work with larger brokers who can refer their clients to us for commission.

5/ Up-selling:

We can cajole customers who we feel can pay for a new truck and can refer them to our new truck showrooms.

6/ Marketing and Sales force:

We should do targeted marketing to reach out to potential used truck buyers in India

We must ensure a good team of sales force who can explain the benefits of 'n'-point checks that has been done on used vehicle and show as to how our trucks are different from trucks offered by brokers.

7/ Location:

We should set up the stores in location (cities and towns) that are close to target customers (Low income group, small commercial setups etc) and minimize the transportation costs. It may be located away from new truck showrooms.

8/ Financing:

Since LTV of 85% is needed we may tie up with financing firms. We can provide EMI schemes. Collateral will be the used truck etc

At this point she stopped me and said that these were

	the key points that they told the client. She continued with other PI questions.
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What do you think went right for you in the in this interview?	I believe she liked the case analysis and then was keen on knowing me more. She made some jokes too towards the end!
Any tips for the future batches based on this Interview experience.	For cases: Come out with your own structures on the fly if need be. Always take a moment to gather your thoughts before venturing in with a proposal. Try to figure out from your interviewer (indirectly of course!) whether numerical analysis is needed.

Name	Viraj Vikram Singh
Company Interviewed With	Accenture Management Consulting (AMC)
Name of Interviewer and Designation	Nilesh (Partner, India Business) along with HR Manager
Round (First/Second/Third round)	Third (Partner round clubbed with HR)

Personal interview Questions(with indicative answers if you choose to share them)	Nilesh had come in PPT at Hyderabad 1/ I will not ask you Why consulting or Why Accenture as you may have responded to that already! So why do you think you fit in this role given your prior experience? I again described my role and asserted that it involved other soft skills which are transferable. 2/ Your experience may not be directly utilized so we may have to discount that up. Is it ok for you? Since I was keen to switch career to consulting I replied in affirmative. 3/ As per you what attributes are most important for a
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consultant?

I said customer empathy is very important but then we should not get biased by client thought process and must offer fresh perspectives and dimensions.

Problem solving is an obvious attribute.

Finally rapport is key to having a long term relationship.

4/ Can you describe me a new product development flow and tell me the areas where firms go wrong? (I was into IC module design and so this question came up)

I draw the complete flow that I had at my last firm and discussed factors that cause failures. It was a detailed discussion.

5/ (After I mentioned focus group somewhere and used movie as an example) But Mr XYZ (a famous Indian personality!) too tried focus groups and the movie was a flop?

I said that focus groups shall be formed correctly and discussed some attributes of it. Then there was a long discussion on uncertainty!

6/ So what's the point, if there is uncertainty still remaining after you do all research etc?

I said that even both of us will live to see the world tomorrow is not 100% certain (Nilesh smiled at that!). We are talking of improving the degree of certainty here.

When AMC says "From Issue to outcome with pace, certainty and strategic agility" you don't mean to offer 100% certainty to clients but what you mean is that you improve the chances of a favorable event happening. (He gave a mysterious smile and offered HR Manager to ask other questions)

	Questions by the HR Managers 5/ But I will ask you again as to Why Accenture?! I mentioned client engagement aspect. I used the PPT data that 99% of AMC clients spend 5 years with AMC and 95% spend up-to 10 years which speaks volumes about the nature
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	of solutions that AMC proposes. Fact that AMC focus on personal development. I mentioned that AMC has spent \$1B on it in the last year (as told in PPT) Chance to work across real strategy projects across different verticals and the learning it brings. There were few other generic questions which I can't recall. They discussed the domain that I may fit into and asked to leave and finally gave the offer.
Narration of the case interview (please be as descriptive as possible)	No Case (Case is usually not done at Partner or HR round)
What do you think went right for you in the in this interview?	The fact that I attended the PPT and thoroughly studied about AMC helped me to strike a chord with Nilesh. I again saw all the videos (on YouTube) that were shown in PPT and understood about the business of AMC well through its website.

Any tips for the future batches based on this Interview experience.	You must know the partners well to have a personal touché while interacting. Partner is only looking at your ability to have intelligent discussions with your clients. HR round is mainly for role and culture fit. Besides, traveling to Mohali a day before may be very tiring and you may not get a proper sleep a night before. Since Mohali campus was new for Hyderabad folks, we have to search for the venues mainly at the start of day and there were some confusion. So do visit the campus even before your scheduled time if you are staying in hotel and roam around the place to identify your interview venues. Do carry chocolates, fruits or whatever energizes you as you may have to run from one interview to other without a break in between.
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	Do remember that almost everyone gets placed by the end of placement process so do not let any reject affect you mainly when you have further rounds scheduled later in the day. Finally do enjoy the sumptuous Chandigarh cuisines if you are new to the place!
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AT KEARNEY

Name	Tarang Bakshi
Company Interviewed With	A T Kearney
Name of Interviewer and Designation	Mr. Ram , Principal
Round (First/Second/Third round)	First
Personal interview Questions(with indicative answers if you choose to share them)	○ Read my resume in front of me. I had some lean six sigma certifications from University of Michigan. Ram was a U of M alum; asked me about which professor taught me and what all he taught me. ○ Asked me about something that was not on the resume; I talked about my backpacking

	trip before joining ISB.
Case Question	Your client is a global pharmaceutical giant; currently they have a blockbuster drug X that constitutes a significant share of its revenues. The patent for these drugs expires in 6 months. The next potential blockbuster drug is 2 years away from market launch. Can you help company sustain its top line and bottom line?
Narration of the case interview (please be as descriptive as possible)	The problem was simple; company's cash cow would be coming under attack from competition in near future. I asked about other drugs that the company was currently selling, but Ram told me to focus on maintaining revenue from this particular drug X. I wrote down the drivers for the sale of this particular medicine and Ram quickly picked sales force reallocation as a major concern. We talked about how sales force can be reallocated to sustain sales of drug X. (don't remember much of this case, but none of it was rocket science)
What do you think went right	This was my first interview of the day and I don't think it

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for you in the in this interview?	went very well.
Any tips for the future batches based on this Interview experience.	If you get an opportunity to make a small talk with the interviewer, grab it. Make him like you 😊

Name	Tarang Bakshi
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Company Interviewed With	A T Kearney
Name of Interviewer and Designation	Mr. Nitin Chandra, Manager
Round (First/Second/Third round)	Second
Personal interview Questions(with indicative answers if you choose to share them)	- o I and Nitin had talked for a while during the pre interview dinner event. I was comforted seeing Nitin as my next interviewer. - o Typical tell me about yourselves questions; asked about other interviews that I was giving on Day1. Given my other interviews, it was obvious that ATK was my first choice so I didn't get any 'why ATK?' question
\Case Question	An Automobile manufacturer from south east Asia imports car into the Indian market. It is now planning to setup a manufacturing facility in India. Should it go ahead with the idea?
Narration of the case interview (please be as descriptive as possible)	I started asking questions about the company and the kind of cars it was selling. Nitin said that the company was exporting compacts to India. I had a surprised look on my face and Nitin questioned me why. I said that it made little sense to import compact cars; he corrected him selves and said that the

	company imported midsize sedans. I also asked about the sales volumes, prices and margins. This was a go/no go decision and I made a simple cost benefit analysis of the situation. I talked about the cost associated with setting up a manufacturing plant in India (fixed set up costs, potential drop in quality, difficulty in getting suppliers, moving backwards on the learning curve, regulatory issues). Then I talked about the benefits of setting up a plant in India (manufacturing flexibility, better manage demand fluctuations, elimination of import duties, opportunity to manufacture & support more car variants) Based on the numbers that Nitin gave me, I calculated the breakeven volumes. Based on current sales, the breakeven period came to be around 3 years, which I thought was a good number. We ended the case by talking about ways to start manufacturing operations in India; we primarily discussed about JV's on the lines of HM-Mitsubishi and Toyota Kirloskar.
What do you think went right for you in the in this interview?	The case was simple; ATK was looking for people who could engage clients into meaningful discussions.
Any tips for the future batches based on this Interview experience.	Talk to people during dinner events before interviews. At a minimum knowing your interviewer beforehand makes you comfortable during the interview.

Name	Tarang Bakshi
Company Interviewed With	A T Kearney

Name of Interviewer and Designation	Mr. Kaushik, Partner
Round (First/Second/Third round)	Third
Personal interview Questions(with indicative answers if you choose to share them)	○ Again, we had talked during the dinner event so we knew each other a bit beforehand. ○ Asked 'about yourselves', 'why consulting', 'how would your colleagues describe you' ○ He figured it out from my resume that I was kind of a 'solo' guy .i first complemented him by saying that he was right in thinking so, but also told how this side of my personality did not affect work in any way.
Case Question	Very open ended case. Employees of company X are unhappy. Why?

Narration of the case interview (please be as descriptive as possible)	The only question, I asked was about the company's financial performance. Kaushik said, the growth had been stellar in past few years. I tackled this case with a people, process, technology framework People: - • HR policies • How managers were promoted and evaluated • How employees were evaluated, promoted and compensated • Work hours, work environment Process: • Were job roles defines properly? • Org structure; poor co-ordination between departments\ • Level of Autonomy with the management • Hire and fire policy Technology:
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	• Old assets/machinery • Frequent breakdowns in operation The fact was that speedy growth had put strain on company's people, processes and technologies. Each of this bullet point was discussed in this context. e.g – if the company did not fire inefficient people during the growth phase, then the efficient people (who would be fewer in numbers) would be under enormous stress to achieve growth targets.
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What do you think went right for you in the in this interview?	There was no right answer to this case. It as a casual discussion and pretty much everything went right 😊
Any tips for the future batches based on this Interview experience.	

Name	Tarang Bakshi
Company Interviewed With	A T Kearney
Name of Interviewer and Designation	Mr. Vikas, Partner
Round (First/Second/Third round)	Fourth
Personal interview Questions(with indicative answers if you choose to share them)	○ Did not ask me much, in fact he asked if I had questions for him ○ I asked him to reflect back on his career in consulting ; Vikas gave a pretty insightful answer

Narration of the case interview (please be as descriptive as possible)	Case: No case He told me to fill up an income statement template for a cookie manufacturer and for a mining company (as% of sales). I used some common sense to fill it up. Since the mining business was more risky, I arrived at a higher net profit for the mining company than the cookie company. That was the case and he started discussing the offer with me.
What do you think went right for you in the in this interview?	All my interviews went in quick succession, so I was in the zone and ready to tackle cases. In this case, just a basic risk reward principal was all that I needed to keep in mind. Keep it simple 😊
Any tips for the future batches based on this Interview experience.	If you are to ask the interviewer any question, make it as personal as you can. In a 30 min interview Vikas spent 15 mins talking about himself and in an excited manner. Engage the interviewer, listen to him, and make him like you.

Name	ANSHUL SINGHAL
Company Interviewed With	A.T. KEARNEY
Name of Interviewer and Designation	Nitin Chandra (Principal)
Round (First/Second/Third round)	Round 1 Interview 1

Personal interview Questions(with indicative answers if you choose to share them)	Started the interview with three questions 1) What makes you distinct from other ISB grads? 2) Why is IIT GPA on the lower side? 3) Why is ISB GPA so good? Some chitchat about my work experience and the kind of role I was doing in my previous company
Case Question	Since my background is from power sector, he asked me a power sector case <u>Case Statement:</u> Our client wants to set up a power plant in India. How would you go about it?
Narration of the case interview (please be as descriptive as possible)	Started by asking the objective of setting up the plant. I also asked about specific details like land and money availability etc. It turned out that client had a lot of cash and had no idea of how to set up the power plant but wanted to do it anyways. I broke down various stages of setting up power plants as – 1) Approvals and Resource acquisition stage 2) Construction stage 3) Operation Stage He asked me to concentrate on the first stage. I listed down key criteria like land acquisition, fuel linkages, power purchase agreements etc. He seemed to be satisfied with my approach and stopped me on the case. He then checked about my sector knowledge by asking few general questions like Price/Mw for various types of power including renewable, general industry trends, gas price trends etc.

What do you think went right for you in the in this interview?	The interviewer was mainly checking my industry knowledge through PI as well as the case. Luckily, I had revised these things before the interview and hence could answer them well.
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Any tips for the future batches based on this Interview experience.	Get your industry knowledge very thorough. Also be ready for not-so-standard cases where you need to improvise a structure and solve the case.
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Name	ANSHUL SINGHAL
Company Interviewed With	A.T. KEARNEY
Name of Interviewer and Designation	Vikas Kaushal (Partner)
Round (First/Second/Third round)	Round 1 Interview 2
Personal interview Questions(with indicative answers if you choose to share them)	He did not ask any PI questions and directly jumped to the case.
Case Question	Case was about a minerals company having two divisions: mining and smelting. He gave a set of numbers and asked profit margins for each of the divisions (typical MADM transfer pricing). Then he asked me whether these profit margin numbers made sense considering the nature of their businesses of these divisions.
Narration of the case interview (please be as descriptive as possible)	I started by understanding the value chain of both the divisions. I told him smelting would have higher return as it is more capital intensive and adds more value than a labor intensive mining business where one just digs the mineral out. Turns out the solution was mining is a riskier business

	than smelting because of uncertainty in amount of mineral and govt. regulations etc., hence investors would demand a higher return on mining division than for the smelting division. He drew a blank income statement for both divisions. He wrote the final net income number for both of them and asked me to go bottom up on the income statement and fill the rest of the numbers. We had a long discussion on each of the line items on what the reasonable number should be and how does it differ among divisions due to the nature of their business.
What do you think went right for you in the in this interview?	He drilled really deep into MADM and FADM concepts and luckily I could answer all the questions confidently (sometimes incorrectly too). Vikas and I had a good discussion on power sector after the case which ended the interview on a very positive note.
Any tips for the future batches based on this Interview experience.	Learn your accounting well as it can come anytime to haunt you 😊. Read about the interviewer's area of interest before as it helps to make intelligent talk in the interview.

Name	ANSHUL SINGHAL
Company Interviewed With	A.T. KEARNEY
Name of Interviewer and Designation	Ram Kidambi (Principal)
Round (First/Second/Third round)	Round 2 Interview 1
Personal interview Questions(with indicative answers if you choose to share	Standard PI questions 1) Tell me something about yourself? 2) Strengths and weaknesses.

them)	
Case Question	A large multinational company has declared its last year's financial results and has exceeded all expectations. Your client, CEO of this company, wonders that despite good performance, the discontent among its employees for the organization is increasing. Help him identify the reasons and possible recommendations to counter the situation.
Narration of the case interview (please be as descriptive as possible)	Divided the possible causes using the People Process Infrastructure framework which he instantly disliked. He said you are the 6 th person from the morning drawing the same framework. Nevertheless, he asked me to continue with it and identify the causes. I came up with quite a few possible causes of discontent among employees. He kept on pushing me to think more and come up with few more. I didn't know whether he was looking for a specific cause or not but after I identified 1-2 more, he asked me to switch to recommendation of tackling these causes. I came up with things like employee engagement, 360o feedback etc.
What do you think went right for you in the in this interview?	Nothing except that I did well in PI part of the interview. In the case, once the framework thing happened, I was playing catch up all the time. However, interviewer was satisfied that I had covered all aspects of the problem and didn't give up even when pushed to think for more possible reasons.

Any tips for the future batches based on this Interview experience.	Try and avoid standard frameworks as interviewers tend not to appreciate it. Rather show a logical approach of solving the problem rather than get bound by the boundaries of the framework. Frameworks can act as a guide in your mind. Make sure that you are at ease and make a conversation rather than Q&A session. Having a connect with the interviewer really helps.
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Name	ANSHUL SINGHAL
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Company Interviewed With	A.T. KEARNEY
Name of Interviewer and Designation	Kaushik Madhavan (Partner)
Round (First/Second/Third round)	Round 2 Interview 2
Personal interview Questions(with indicative answers if you choose to share them)	1) Tell me something about yourself? 2) What is the biggest challenge you have faced in your life and how did you face it? After giving me the case, Kaushik enquired about my role at L&T and asked me questions like revenue and net profit of L&T for last year. We had a long conversation on Chinese competition entering Indian markets and which internal L&T group companies were getting affected the most. We discussed on possible solutions of countering this problem. At the end of the interview after asking a lot of L&T specific questions, Kaushik told me that he used to work with L&T.

Case Question	He made a case out of my resume points. I had done a power plant bidding process optimization in L&T resulting in a reduction of cycle time by 2%. He said your problem statement is to make it 50%.
Narration of the case interview (please be as descriptive as possible)	I laid down a flow chart depicting the process followed at L&T. Then, I calculated the estimated time taken for each process and focused on most time consuming process first. I tried to identify potential sources of delay and went about suggesting solutions. In the end, I gave the recommendation that only around 10% reduction was possible and that 50% reduction in time is unrealistic at this moment. Kaushik seemed satisfied with my analysis.
What do you think went right for you in the in this interview?	The conversation seemed to be flowing and there was a comfort level for me as he was talking about my work experience almost all the time.
Any tips for the future batches	Don't try to blindly follow the standard case structures as

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based on this Interview experience.	they might help you to a certain extent. For me, almost all the cases were pretty non-standard and I had to improvise the structure. Be confident and always take a buy-in from the interview on what you are doing. Also, if you have multiple shortlists, get your pecking order very clear in your head as you might not have time to attend all the interviews on that day. Outcome: Made an offer
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Name	Indrajit Mal
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Company Interviewed With	A. T. Kearney
Name of Interviewer and Designation	Vikas Kaushal, Partner
Round (First/Second/Third round)	1 st interview, Round 1 (First interview of the day)
Personal interview Questions(with indicative answers if you choose to share them)	None. It was my first interview of the day. He introduced himself and jumped into the case without wasting any time.
Case Question	An integrated copper producer (mining to smelting to selling copper bars) was experiencing losses for last 3-4 years.
Narration of the case interview (please be as descriptive as possible)	Approach: Started off by asking basic questions about the company operations, industry. Used the profitability framework to try and pin down to revenue or cost side. Drew a value chain to understand the entire operations. Several numbers were provided by the interviewer. Solution: Even after doing all the typical stuff for a profitability case, I was not able to pin point the issue and was only able to identify a broad problem. The interviewer provided the solution at the end. I was completely baffled by the answer because then I realized that I had misunderstood some facts and made some wrong assumptions right at the problem definition stage. I have not included details of this case here for the same reason (should be available in others records).
What do you think went right for you in the in this interview?	Almost nothing!
Any tips for the future batches based on this interview experience.	1. The day's first interview can be a bit tricky, it is extremely important to pay high level of attention when the interviewer is explaining the case or giving data. I even asked for the same data point more than 2 times – Never forget to take notes. It might even be worthwhile to do a practice case before getting

	into the first interview room. 2. While nothing went right in this interview, this experience provided me
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	with a very important takeaway – “Do not let the earlier interviews get into your head, during anytime of the day”. It may sound very obvious, but it’s not easy, I have seen many of my friends getting affected by this. If an interview goes bad, just remember the term ‘sunk cost’.
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Name	Kiran Kumar G
Company Interviewed With	AT Kearney
Name of Interviewer and Designation	Partner - Kaushik
Round (First/Second/Third round)	First
Personal interview Questions(with indicative answers if you choose to share them)	Mostly CV based questions and general interests. PI went on for more time than I expected so couldn't get to the case.
What do you think went right for you in the in this interview?	PI went really well, all the effort on tell me about yourself paid off spectacularly.

Any tips for the future batches based on this Interview experience.	You need to give a lot of time and effort to the PI questions. Most of the time the differentiating factor tends to be PI as everybody generally does a decent job on cases after a month of preparation. This especially true for Booz, AT Kearney etc.
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Name	Kiran Kumar G
Company Interviewed With	AT Kearney
Name of Interviewer and Designation	Mayank Bansal (Principal)
Round (First/Second/Third round)	Second
Personal interview Questions(with indicative answers if you choose to share them)	Generic CV and work-ex related stuff again
Case Question	The case was described as follows: "You are meeting Cyrus Mistry as he is taking over the reins in Tata group. What suggestion recommendation will you give him going forward?"

Narration of the case interview (please be as descriptive as possible)	I started out with looking at the existing businesses and plot them on a 2*2 with Return vs market size as metrics for businesses but quickly realized that Mayank wanted me to give a future outlook for Tata group rather than improving current profitability which the CEO might know of anyways. So tried to plot the existing industries in a single 2*2 with ROE vs. market size kind of metric and moved on to looking at potential new business opportunities for expansion of the tata group on a Risk adjusted return on investment vs. Potential market size kind of 2*2. Had a lengthy discussion on why risk adjusted return makes sense rather than just using ROE (which tends to be higher for riskier businesses). Then worked on mapping the goals on a short, medium and long term perspective. Short term included more metrics on existing businesses and medium term focused on new avenues to enter. The other discussion we had was around how to manage
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	such broad diversification as financial markets in India continues to mature. This point was well appreciated in terms of the long term perspective.
What do you think went right for you in the in this interview?	I judged what Mayank was looking for from the case pretty early and tweaked the usual BCG matrix to include risk adjusted return based on my experience. I was able to personalize the answer from my experience in subprime business and the way we do capital allocation across subprime and up market businesses which got Mayank very interested.

Any tips for the future batches based on this Interview experience.	There seems to be lot more broad based cases nowadays so it pays off to be calm and make it into a good discussion with many potential solutions rather trying to find that one good solution.
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Name	Kiran Kumar G
Company Interviewed With	AT Kearney
Name of Interviewer and Designation	N/A
Round (First/Second/Third round)	Third
Personal interview Questions(with indicative answers if you choose to share them)	Jumped right into the case
Case Question	There is an electric motors company which has seen its profits and revenues decline over the past 5 years.

Narration of the case interview (please be as descriptive as possible)	I started with laying out the value chain as follows: Raw materials -> inbound logistics - >manufacturing/assembly ->outbound logistics -> customers I soon realized the falling revenues were due to delayed shipment of orders and that it was problem due to poor manufacturing performance and the COO was worried about this. Diving into manufacturing and assembly, I came to realize that it was a company which made electric motors (which are used in fans etc.). Used the People, process, infrastructure framework to identify the root cause. But the interviewer was interested only in the laundry list of potential bottle necks: So listed it down under: 1) Capacity and 2) Efficiency, then went into the concepts learnt in operation management starting with: 1) Poor set up times 2) High cycle times due to bad batching 3) Frequent breakdowns of bottleneck resource
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	(mentioned power cuts as well considering the Indian scenario, interviewer appreciated this 😊) 4) Highly Variable demand and production times 5) Supply chain (ERP) 6) Labor skills
What do you think went right for you in the in this interview?	Was able to give all the potential issues and he kept encouraging me saying things like “We found set times to be the issue what else?”, so had confidence to go further
Any tips for the future batches based on this Interview experience.	Jagmohan Raju’s material and Operation strategy are the 2 most important courses that you need to know very well. It helps tremendously while solving cases.

Name	Kiran Kumar G
Company Interviewed With	AT Kearney
Name of Interviewer and Designation	Partner – Vikas Kaushal
Round (First/Second/Third round)	Fourth
Personal interview Questions(with indicative answers if you choose to share them)	It was my fourth continuous interview of the day with AT Kearney and PI was again some generic questions on CV and Work-ex.
Case Question	An integrated mining copper mining and smelting company has been making losses for the past few years and we need to suggest a turnaround plan for them.
Narration of the case interview (please be as descriptive as possible)	As I was trying to draw the value chain I realized that the problem was with the mining unit and the smelting unit costs were on par with the industry average. Basically realized that the transfer price charged by the mining company to the smelting unit was much higher than the industry. We then tried to do a profitability analysis by breaking down revenues and costs into P&L statement: Revenue – expenses = EBITDA + Interest + Depreciation = PBT. Was analyzing this for both mining and smelting when the time of interview was up and was given an offer.
What do you think went right for you in the in this interview?	By this time I knew I had done well enough to get an offer one of the good decisions I took was to stick out and finish all four interviews together rather than finishing only 2.
Any tips for the future batches based on this	For people with multiple shortlists be prepared with a list of top 4 companies you will be interviewing with.

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